

Newsom blasts Trump’s tactics

He says the president intentionally inflamed tensions in L.A., in speech that drew Democrats’ praise.

By TARYN LUNA

SACRAMENTO — With federal troops occupying the streets of downtown Los Angeles and immigration agents carrying out indiscriminate raids across the city, Gov. Gavin Newsom forcefully rebuked President’s Trump claim that militarization was necessary to control the protests and offered an alternative vision of leadership for a nation in turmoil.

“Donald Trump’s government isn’t protecting our communities — they’re traumatizing our communities,” Newsom said in a speech Tuesday shared on social media during the prime-time hour. “And that seems to be the entire point.”

The governor released the speech hours after Trump said at Ft. Bragg in North Carolina that he sent in the California National Guard and the U.S. Marines to protect immigration agents from “the attacks of a vicious and violent mob.” By standing up and countering Trump’s assertions, Newsom endeared himself to Democrats who are hungry for a leader who isn’t afraid to fight back.

“He looked like a real leader,” said Celinda Lake, a national Democratic pollster based in Washington, D.C. “I thought he made a really clear point. He looked extremely authentic. He was strong. He looked like the kind of person you’d want in charge of your state, in charge of your city and in charge of your country.”

Newsom portrayed a sharply different reality to the White House’s version of events that led to the federal takeover of Los Angeles, contending that Trump intentionally fanned the flames of the protests and pulled “a military dragnet” across the city, endangering peaceful protesters and tar-

[See Newsom, A9]

Federal charges

Protesters are accused of serious crimes, but others were in minor skirmishes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Media treatment

Journalists have been shot with less-lethal rounds, shoved and detained. **CALIFORNIA, B1**



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

CALIFORNIA National Guard troops protect a federal building in downtown L.A. as workers remove graffiti.

Images, spin and distortion

Driverless Waymo vehicles, coated with graffiti and engulfed in flames. Masked protesters, dancing and cavorting around burning American flags. Anonymous figures brazenly blocking streets and shutting down major freeways, raining bottles and rocks on the police, while their compatriots waved Mexican flags.

The images flowing out of Los Angeles over nearly a week of protests against federal immigration raids have cast America’s second most populous city as a terrifying hellscape, where lawbreakers rule the streets and regular citizens should fear to leave their homes.

In the relentless fever loop of online and broadcast video, it does not matter that the vast majority of Los Angeles neighborhoods remain safe and secure. Digital images create their own reality and it’s one that President Trump and his sup-

Angelenos and local leaders reject portrayal of an L.A. about to be ‘completely obliterated’

By JAMES RAINEY



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

A PROTESTER waving a Mexican/American flag taunts CHP officers holding a skirmish line Tuesday.

porters have used to condemn L.A. as a place that is “out of control” and on the brink of total collapse.

The images and their true meaning and context have become the subject of a furious debate in the media and among political partisans, centered on the true roots and victims of the protests, which erupted on Friday as the Trump administration moved aggressively to expand its arrests of undocumented immigrants.

As the president and his supporters in conservative media tell it, he is the defender of law and order and American values. They cast their opponents as dangerous foreign-born criminals and their feckless enablers in the Democratic Party and mainstream media.

The state’s political leaders and journalists offer a compelling rebuttal: that Trump touched off several

[See Images, A9]

ICE crackdown expands to agriculture sites

Farms and packinghouses see ‘uptick in the chaotic presence’ of agents



MICHAEL OWEN BAKER For The Times

FARMWORKERS in a strawberry field in Oxnard. Several farms were visited by ICE on Tuesday.

By JESSICA GARRISON, MELISSA GOMEZ AND ANDREA CASTILLO

Alarm spread through California agricultural centers Tuesday as panicked workers reported that federal immigration authorities — who had largely refrained from major enforcement action in farming communities in the first months of the Trump administration — were showing up at farm fields and packinghouses from the Central Coast to the San Joaquin Valley.

“Today we are seeing an uptick in the chaotic presence of immigration enforcement, particularly the Border Patrol,” said Elizabeth Strater, vice president of the United Farm Workers. “We’re seeing it in multiple areas.”

Department of Homeland Security officials declined to confirm specific locations but said enforcement actions were taking place across the southern area of the state. Advocates from numerous immigrant advocacy groups said their phones were lighting up with

[See Raids, A8]

Calmer center as raids sweep region

Downtown L.A. sees less unrest overnight under curfew. Officials and residents take stock of last few days.

By SUMMER LIN, JAMES QUEALLY, RICHARD WINTON, HANNAH FRY AND ANDREA CASTILLO

Amid a new curfew and signs that the unrest in downtown Los Angeles was easing, the sweeping federal immigration crackdown that sparked days of protests appeared to be gaining steam across many parts of the region — from suburban retail centers to farmland in Ventura County.

The White House confirmed on Wednesday that 330 people have been taken into custody by federal authorities since immigration sweeps began last week in Los Angeles. White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt said of those, 113 individuals, or about a third of the group, had prior criminal convictions.

There were growing reports of scattered immigration arrests around the county, many at worksites, heightening anxieties among those in the country illegally. In Downey, immigration agents took an elderly man dropping his granddaughter off at school into custody, and arrested individuals at a Home Depot and LA Fitness, Councilman Mario Trujillo said.

“They are creating havoc and fear,” Trujillo said during a news conference.

One of the more dramatic

[See Curfew, A7]

Fears of detention upend life in L.A.

By CONNOR SHEETS

Hundreds of eighth-graders in freshly ironed button-down shirts and flowing dresses filed into Andrew Carnegie Middle School with their families Tuesday morning in high spirits.

But the graduation festivities at the school in Carson had an ominous undertone, as word had spread ahead of the event that U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement might make an unwanted appearance.

Nervous parents and educators browsed apps dedicated to tracking ICE activity, refreshed their social media feeds and conferred with one another about the latest rumors. Some students who had been expected to attend the event did not come to the stage when their names were called. They had chosen to stay home out of fear that they or their loved ones would be detained.

Similar scenes have played out repeatedly across Los Angeles County in recent days, with the Trump administration deploying swarms of federal agents to detain immigrants.

In neighborhoods with large populations of foreign-born people across the region, every commute, trip to the grocery store or school drop-off has come to represent another potential final moment in lives built in this country.

In the span of just a few hours Tuesday, unverified messages posted online rap-

[See Fears, A8]

BRIAN WILSON, 1942 – 2025

The genius but often-fragile force behind the Beach Boys

By STEVE MARBLE

Brian Wilson, the musical savant who scripted a defining Southern California soundtrack with the Beach Boys before being pulled down by despair and depression in full public view, has died. He was 82.

Wilson’s family announced his death Wednesday morning on Facebook. “We are at a loss for words right now,” the post said.

“Please respect our privacy at this time as our family is grieving. We realize we are sharing our grief with the world,” said the statement, which was also shared on Instagram and the musician’s website.

The statement didn’t reveal a cause of death. Wilson died more than a year after it was revealed he was diagnosed with dementia and placed under a conservatorship in May 2024. For decades, Wilson battled mental health issues and drug addiction.

[See Wilson, A13]



BRIAN VAN DER BRUG Los Angeles Times

NOT ALL SUN AND FUN

Brian Wilson wrote Top 40 anthems to the surf and fun. But he also struggled with mental illness and addiction most of his life.

MUSIC VISIONARY: Brian Wilson was more than brilliant; his sound epitomized the lore of Southern California. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Salton Sea odor raises concerns

High levels of a toxic gas near lake trigger health worries in nearby communities. **SCIENCE, A10**

Weinstein guilty of sexual assault

Disgraced producer is acquitted of another charge and jury is hung on a third. **NATION, A16**

Sheriff oversight official is ousted

Robert Bonner says he wants to stay as watchdog to complete crucial tasks. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Turning sunny.
L.A. Basin: 79/60. **B6**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A14**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.



7 85944 00200 5